



Orthognathic Surgery: Lower Jaw (Mandibular Osteotomy)

Purpose: Surgical repositioning of the lower jaw to correct functional or aesthetic issues such as bite problems, asymmetry, or sleep apnea.

First 24–48 Hours:

- Swelling and bruising will be significant; peak swelling usually occurs within 48–72 hours.
- Apply ice packs externally in 20-minute intervals for the first 48 hours.
- Keep head elevated when resting to reduce swelling.
- Avoid spitting, rinsing, or using straws during the first 24 hours.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Take prescribed pain medications on schedule.
- Numbness in the lips, chin, or tongue is common and may be temporary or permanent.

Oral Hygiene:

- Use a prescribed antimicrobial rinse as directed.
- Gently brush teeth with a soft toothbrush, avoiding surgical areas.
- Irrigation syringes may be provided to clean food from the surgical site.

Diet:

- Follow a liquid or pureed diet as recommended by your surgeon.
- Avoid chewing until cleared by your provider.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid strenuous activity for at least 2 weeks.
- Do not smoke or consume alcohol during healing.
- Rubber bands or fixation devices may be in place; follow all instructions.

Follow-Up:

- Attend all post-op visits for monitoring and adjustments.
- Contact the office if there is sudden swelling, high fever, difficulty breathing, or signs of infection.